ZAINAH ABULHAWA, M.S., M.B.A.

TECHNICAL PROGRAM & PORTFOLIO LEADERSHIP | DATA & AI | STRATEGY & OPERATIONS

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical program and portfolio leader with 12+ years of experience directing cross-functional initiatives across strategy, operations, data, and technology. Lead a $9.5M portfolio spanning 31 international markets and an eight-member multidisciplinary team. Experienced in financial and resource management, program delivery, risk, stakeholder engagement, analytics, dashboards, and executive decision support. Background includes federal civilian and defense programs, capture and proposal support, and graduate studies in data science and AI.

EDUCATION

M.S., Data Science, Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning — Old Dominion University | Current
MBA — University of North Carolina | May 2026
M.S., Global Health — Georgetown University | May 2018

CORE COMPETENCIES

Technical Program & Portfolio Management | Strategy & Operations | Cross-Functional Leadership | Program Delivery | Budget & Resource Planning | Risk Management | KPI Development | Data Analytics & Visualization | Stakeholder Engagement | Capture & Proposal Management | Acquisition & Contract Support

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Booz Allen Hamilton | Lead Associate/ Program Manager April 2023–Present

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) – Administration for Strategic Preparedness and Response (ASPR) – Biomedical Advanced Research and Development Authority (BARDA)

- Lead end-to-end project management for BARDA industrial base expansion programs valued at approximately $3.2B. Apply Project Management Institute (PMI) PMBOK best practices across the full project lifecycle, including initiation, planning, execution, monitoring and controlling, and closeout, with oversight of project scope, schedules, budgets, resources, deliverables, stakeholder engagement, risk mitigation, and performance metrics to ensure alignment with program objectives and federal requirements..
- Build dashboards, budget and milestone trackers, risk registers, and executive reporting using Power BI, Excel, and portfolio management tools.
- Oversee supply chain management and logistics operations for BARDA medical countermeasure and biological specimen inventories through interagency agreements (IAAs) involving PSC and Fisher BioServices. Manage inventory oversight, storage and distribution coordination, shipment tracking, chain-of-custody documentation, and compliance with federal requirements, while coordinating with interagency stakeholders and logistics partners to ensure inventory accountability, operational readiness, and supply chain efficiency.
- Coordinate with federal program leaders, contracting and agreements personnel, manufacturers, consortium partners, technical experts, and senior stakeholders.
- Support proposal development and capture management across civilian and defense markets, serving in proposal management, writing, coordination, and capture-support roles for opportunities representing more than $862M in potential market value.

LMI Consulting LLC | November 2021–April 2023

HHS/ ASPR/BARDA— Sr. Analyst /Programmatic Project Manager

- Managed and supported an approximately $3.2B contract portfolio involving domestic and international COVID-19 test manufacturers, tracking production, supply chain risks, deliverables, and performance.
- Prepared technical evaluations, acquisition and funding memoranda, sole-source justifications, independent government cost estimates, invoices, project reports, and milestone documentation.
- Led manufacturing industry engagement on capacity, disruptions, operational risks, and product availability; supported BARDA vaccines and therapeutics through market research and project tracking.
- Created analytical reports, dashboards, and executive briefings with Power BI and Excel to support ASPR decision-making.

U.S Department of War, United States Southern Command | June 2020–Nov 2021 (Dengue Longitudinal Study Support ongoing) *Office of the Command Surgeon, Oak Ridge Institute for Science and Education — Fellow*

- Lead a $9.5M portfolio across 31 international markets, overseeing strategy, execution, budgeting, resources, risks, stakeholders, and performance across multiple initiatives.
- Guide an eight-member cross-functional team, align deliverables with priorities, manage dependencies, and track outcomes, schedules, budgets, and KPIs.
- Create program plans and reporting frameworks; integrate financial, operational, contract, supply-chain, and performance data into dashboards and executive recommendations.
- Engage military and civilian leaders, diplomats, government officials, and regional partners in Latin America and the Caribbean to assess gaps and establish investment priorities.
- Designed an enterprise response capability, including governance, SOPs, workflows, escalation, reporting architecture, KPIs, and performance management.
- Conducted regional quantitative and qualitative analysis, risk assessments, and monitoring to identify trends, operational gaps, and improvement opportunities.
- Briefed senior leadership, including Admiral Craig Faller, translating regional risks and complex findings into recommended courses of action.

Henry M. Jackson Foundation | April 2019–June 2020

Research Associate, Uniformed Services University of the Health Sciences

- Managed program planning, execution, monitoring, and performance evaluation for a $12M initiative, overseeing project timelines, deliverables, resource coordination, stakeholder engagement, and performance metrics to ensure alignment with strategic objectives
- Managed analytics and performance measurements for a $12M initiative; defined metrics, evaluated results, and communicated recommendations.
- Analyzed survey, focus-group, experimental, and statistical data and contributed to $219M+ in strategic proposals and investment opportunities.
- Coordinated technical, research, and executive stakeholders and developed leadership-ready reporting and visualizations.
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Ministry of Health and Family Welfare | August 2018–December 2018

Research Fellow, National Institute of Nutrition — Hyderabad, India

- Led planning, coordination, and execution of a multidisciplinary field research project, managing project activities, timelines, data collection, stakeholder engagement, and deliverables to ensure alignment with research objectives.
- Coordinated cross-functional research teams and collaborated with government officials, healthcare professionals, and community stakeholders to support project implementation and operational effectiveness.
- Conducted quantitative and qualitative research to assess healthcare needs, service delivery gaps, access barriers, and behavioral trends, translating complex findings into actionable recommendations.
- Developed research reports, presentations, and policy recommendations to communicate findings to government stakeholders and inform public health planning, resource allocation, and program improvement.

Georgetown University Global Health Institute | August 2017–August 2019

Research Assistant

- Supported budgeting and cost estimation for a $25M international program and evaluated program alternatives using cost-effectiveness, comparative, and risk analysis.
- Identified operational gaps and lessons learned; taught undergraduate seniors program management, budgeting, implementation, and evaluation.

Vidant Medical Center | August 2015–December 2016

Research Assistant

- Supported research project planning, implementation, and evaluation, coordinating data collection, project milestones, stakeholder engagement, and deliverables to support organizational and operational objectives.
- Designed and implemented comprehensive mixed-methods needs assessments, integrating data analysis, surveys, and stakeholder feedback to identify service gaps, barriers to care, and opportunities for process improvement.

- Analyzed complex healthcare datasets to identify trends, assess program effectiveness, and develop evidence-based recommendations to improve service delivery, resource allocation, and operational efficiency.